

D.J. PARIS

# ONE BAD BET BECAME A SCARY FHA HEADLINE.

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None of it says your buyer's loan is at risk.

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**"THAT IS THE  
PRODUCT OF ONE  
COMPANY'S OWN  
MISJUDGED BET ON  
RATES, NOT ANY  
INDICATION OF  
POORLY  
UNDERWRITTEN FHA  
MORTGAGES."**

Bob Broeksmit, president of the Mortgage Bankers Association, on the WSJ story tying one lender's loss to FHA loans broadly.



## ONE HEADLINE. TWO UNRELATED STORIES, STITCHED TOGETHER.

The Wall Street Journal's "UWM Is a Government Mortgage Canary" tied United Wholesale Mortgage's \$603 million loss on a rate hedge to broader fears about FHA-insured lending. The Mortgage Bankers Association's own president, Bob Broeksmit, published a rebuttal calling it what it was: "conflating a single firm's hedging misstep with FHA's program-wide performance makes for an eye-catching headline," one that "neither informs readers about the health of the FHA program nor the strength of the independent mortgage bank sector." Your buyer's FHA pre-approval didn't get riskier this week. The headline just made it sound that way.



# WHAT TO DO THIS MONTH IF YOU HAVE FHA BUYERS ACTIVE:

## **1 Send a one-line note before they see the headline.**

"Saw the FHA story going around. It's about one lender's hedging bet, not your loan. Nothing about your approval changed."

## **2 Have the lender confirm it in writing, not you.**

A two-line note from their loan officer carries more weight than reassurance from their agent alone.

## **3 Bring it up yourself at the next touchpoint.**

A buyer who reads the headline before you mention it starts wondering what else you're not telling them.



## THE TAKEAWAY

# THE STORY WAS NEVER ABOUT YOUR BUYER'S LOAN.

It was about whether you said something before they had to ask.